# App support · Quick concepts

Interview revision sheet. Read it the evening before, then test yourself in Interview practice.

## ITIL basics

- Incident: unplanned interruption; goal is to restore service fast.
- Problem: root cause of incidents; known error has a documented cause or workaround.
- Service request: standard ask such as access or a password reset.
- Change: standard (pre-approved), normal (CAB), emergency (ECAB).
- Priority = impact x urgency (P1 to P4). SLA covers response and resolution times.

## Support levels

- L1: log, triage, known fixes, escalate. L2: deeper investigation with logs, DB and config.
- L3: developers or vendors for code fixes and complex issues.

## Incident handling

- Restore first, root cause later. Communicate impact, actions, next update time.
- Major incident: incident manager, bridge call, timeline, frequent updates.
- Keep a timeline; write a blameless postmortem with action items.
- RCA techniques: 5 Whys, fishbone diagram.

## HTTP status codes

- 2xx success; 3xx redirect; 4xx client error; 5xx server error.
- 400 bad request, 401 not authenticated, 403 not allowed, 404 not found, 429 rate limited.
- 500 server error, 502 bad gateway (bad upstream response), 503 unavailable, 504 gateway timeout.

## Java issues

- NullPointerException: null reference, check stack trace and input data.
- OutOfMemoryError: heap too small or a leak; take a heap dump.
- Hangs and deadlocks: take several thread dumps (jstack).
- Connection pool exhausted: leaks, slow queries or too small a pool.

## Everyday checks

- Logs: grep, tail -f. Processes: ps -ef. Ports: ss -tlnp, nc -zv host port.
- API: curl -v. DNS: nslookup or dig. Disk: df -h and du -sh.
- Cron failures: environment differences such as PATH.
- Expired SSL certificates: monitor expiry 30 days ahead.

## Interview answers

- Use STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result, with numbers.
- Show ownership, communication and permanent fixes, not just restarts.